MODERN INDIA I · DAY 3 OF 6 · TEST ON 31 OCT 2026

Governors and Governor-Generals: Clive to Dalhousie

Every ruler: what he fought, passed and built · acts · traps

HOW TO USE THIS NOTE

1. Read the overview table first (5 min).
2. Then read section by section. Each ends with the exam traps and links.
3. Finish with the traps and memory hooks, then start the 50 questions.

Overview: how the office evolved

Between 1757 and 1856 the head of Company rule changed title three times. UPSC frequently tests the difference between these titles (Anantam IAS, UPSC 2007 PYQ).

Period	Title	Created by	First holder
1757–1773	Governor of Bengal (Fort William)	Company appointment	Robert Clive
1773–1833	Governor-General of Bengal (Fort William)	Regulating Act, 1773	Warren Hastings
1833–1858	Governor-General of India	Charter Act, 1833	Lord William Bentinck
1858 onwards	Governor-General and Viceroy	Government of India Act, 1858	Lord Canning

Exam trap: Clive was the first *Governor* of Bengal, not Governor-General. Hastings was the first *Governor-General of Bengal*. Bentinck was the first *Governor-General of India*. Canning was the first *Viceroy*.

Master timeline (Clive to Dalhousie)

Name	Tenure	Title	Remember for
Robert Clive	1757–60; 1765–67	Governor of Bengal	Plassey, Treaty of Allahabad, Dual Government, White Mutiny
Henry Vansittart	1760–64	Governor of Bengal	Mir Qasim installed, Battle of Buxar (1764)
Harry Verelst	1767–69	Governor of Bengal	First Anglo-Mysore War (1767–69)
John Cartier	1769–72	Governor of Bengal	Great Bengal Famine (1770)
Warren Hastings	1772–74 Governor; 1774–85 GG	GG of Bengal	End of Dual Govt, Regulating Act, Pitt's India Act, Asiatic Society, Rohilla War, 1st Maratha & 2nd Mysore wars
Sir John Macpherson	1785–86 (acting)	GG of Bengal	Interim
Lord Cornwallis	1786–93	GG of Bengal	Permanent Settlement, Cornwallis Code, civil services, police, 3rd Mysore War
Sir John Shore	1793–98	GG of Bengal	Non-intervention, Charter Act 1793, Battle of Kharda
Lord Wellesley	1798–1805	GG of Bengal	Subsidiary Alliance, 4th Mysore War, 2nd Maratha War, Fort William College
Lord Cornwallis	1805 (died in office)	GG of Bengal	Second short term
Sir George Barlow	1805–07	GG of Bengal	Vellore Mutiny (1806)
Lord Minto I	1807–13	GG of Bengal	Treaty of Amritsar (1809), Charter Act 1813
Lord Hastings (Moira)	1813–23	GG of Bengal	Anglo-Nepal War, Pindaris, 3rd Maratha War, Ryotwari

Name	Tenure	Title	Remember for
Lord Amherst	1823–28	GG of Bengal	1st Anglo-Burmese War, Barrackpore Mutiny
Lord William Bentinck	1828–33 GG of Bengal; 1833–35 GG of India	GG of India	Sati abolition, Thuggee, Charter Act 1833, English Education Act 1835
Sir Charles Metcalfe	1835–36 (acting)	GG of India	Liberator of the Indian Press
Lord Auckland	1836–42	GG of India	1st Anglo-Afghan War
Lord Ellenborough	1842–44	GG of India	Annexation of Sindh, slavery abolished (1843)
Lord Hardinge I	1844–48	GG of India	1st Anglo-Sikh War
Lord Dalhousie	1848–56	GG of India	Doctrine of Lapse, railways, telegraph, post, Wood's Despatch, Awadh annexation

The key constitutional acts of this period

Act	Under	What it did
Regulating Act, 1773	Lord North's ministry; Hastings	First parliamentary control over the Company; Governor of Bengal became GG of Bengal with a 4-member council; Bombay and Madras made subordinate; Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)
Act of Settlement (Amending Act), 1781	Hastings	Limited the Supreme Court's jurisdiction; Company servants exempt for official acts
Pitt's India Act, 1784	Hastings	Board of Control set up; 'dual control' by Company and Crown; council reduced to 3 members
Act of 1786	Cornwallis	GG could override his council; could also be Commander-in-Chief

Act	Under	What it did
Charter Act, 1793	Shore	Company monopoly renewed 20 years; salaries of Board of Control from Indian revenues
Charter Act, 1813	Minto I / Hastings	Trade monopoly ended except tea and trade with China; Rs 1 lakh a year for education; missionaries allowed
Charter Act, 1833	Bentinck	GG of Bengal became GG of India; Company's commercial role ended; Law Member (Macaulay) added; Law Commission; open competition proposed (not implemented)
Charter Act, 1853	Dalhousie	Legislative and executive functions separated; open competition for civil services; charter not renewed for a fixed term

1. Robert Clive (1757–60 and 1765–67)

Clive turned the Company from a trader into a territorial power: Plassey (1757) gave it political control and the Treaty of Allahabad (1765) gave it the Diwani. He was the **first Governor of Bengal** and is called "Clive of India" (Vajiram & Ravi, GKToday).

Background

- Joined the Company as a writer at Fort St. George, Madras (1744); rose during the Carnatic Wars.
- **Siege of Arcot (1751)** in the Second Carnatic War made his military name.
- Recaptured Calcutta in January 1757; **Treaty of Alinagar** (February 1757) restored Company privileges and allowed fortification of Calcutta.

First governorship (1757–1760)

- **Battle of Plassey (23 June 1757):** defeated Siraj-ud-Daulah through the treachery of Mir Jafar, Rai Durlabh, Jagat Seth and Omichand. Mir Jafar made Nawab.

- Received a jagir worth about £30,000 a year (Clive's Jagir, the 24 Parganas rent) from Mir Jafar.
- Repelled the Mughal crown prince (Ali Gauhar, later Shah Alam II).
- Defeated the Dutch at **Chinsurah / Battle of Bedara (1759)**.
- Secured the **Northern Circars** from the French.

Second governorship (1765–1767)

Clive returned in May 1765, after the Company's victory at Buxar (1764).

Treaty of Allahabad (August 1765) — two treaties (GKToday, Vajiram & Ravi on Buxar):

Treaty with	Date	Terms
Shah Alam II (Mughal Emperor)	12 Aug 1765	Granted the **Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa** to the Company; Emperor got Kara and Allahabad and an annual tribute of Rs 26 lakh; lived at Allahabad fort under Company protection
Shuja-ud-Daulah (Nawab of Awadh)	16 Aug 1765	Surrendered Kara and Allahabad to the Emperor; paid Rs 50 lakh war indemnity; Balwant Singh (zamindar of Banaras) confirmed in his estate; Company got duty-free trade in Awadh; Awadh kept as a **buffer state**

Shah Alam II conferred titles on Clive at the signing; the Emperor's farman legalised the Company's gains in Bengal.

Dual Government (Dyarchy) of Bengal, 1765–1772

- **Diwani** (revenue, civil justice) with the Company; **Nizamat** (police, criminal justice, defence) nominally with the Nawab, who received Rs 53 lakh for it.
- The Company controlled the Nizamat too, by nominating the Deputy Subahdar.
- Indian deputies did the actual work: **Muhammad Reza Khan** (Deputy Diwan of Bengal, also Deputy Nazim) and **Raja Shitab Rai** (Deputy Diwan of Bihar).

- Result: power without responsibility. Revenue was squeezed, administration and welfare were neglected, and the system is linked to the **Bengal Famine of 1770**. Abolished by Warren Hastings in 1772.

Administrative and army reforms (second term)

- Company servants forbidden to engage in private trade and to accept presents; had to sign covenants.
- **Society of Trade (1765):** a monopoly of salt, betel nut and tobacco to compensate officers; disallowed by the Court of Directors.
- Abolished **double batta** (field allowance) for officers in peacetime from 1 January 1766. European officers resisted: the **White Mutiny / Monghyr Mutiny (1766)**, which Clive suppressed; Sir Robert Fletcher was cashiered (Wikipedia).
- Reorganised the Bengal Army into brigades.

End of career

- Faced a Parliamentary inquiry (1772–73) over his fortune; was exonerated but died by suicide in **1774**.
- William Pitt the Elder called him a "heaven-born general".

UPSC angle: Plassey gave political power; Buxar and Allahabad made it legal and financial. Dual Government is a favourite Mains theme ("power without responsibility").

> **Memory hook — "Clive PADs the White army"**
>
> - **P**lassey (1757) → **A**llahabad (1765) → **D**ual Government (1765) → **White** Mutiny (1766).
> - Picture: Clive sits on a cushion (PAD) while white-faced officers sulk because he took their double batta.
> - Date trick: **57 + 8 = 65** — Plassey to Allahabad is exactly 8 years. Allahabad has **two** treaties (Emperor and Awadh) because Clive's government was **dual**.

Linkage: Plassey gave a puppet Nawab → puppet tried to be free (Mir Qasim) → Buxar → Allahabad gave Diwani → Dual Government → famine of 1770 → Regulating Act 1773 → Hastings.

2. Between Clive's terms and after: Vansittart, Verelst, Cartier (1760–1772)

These three are minor names but carry two major events: the **Battle of Buxar (1764)** and the **Great Bengal Famine (1770)**.

Henry Vansittart (1760–1764)

- **Mir Qasim made Nawab (1760)** by a secret agreement with Vansittart, replacing Mir Jafar. Mir Qasim ceded the revenue of **Burdwan, Midnapore and Chittagong** to the Company (GKToday).
- Mir Qasim moved his capital from Murshidabad to **Monghyr (Munger)**, modernised his army and tried to rule independently.
- **Dastak dispute:** Company servants misused the duty-free trade permit (dastak, from Farrukhsiyar's 1717 farman) for private trade. Mir Qasim abolished all internal duties so Indian traders were equal; the Calcutta Council refused to accept this.
- War (1763): the Council declared war in July 1763 and restored Mir Jafar. Mir Qasim lost at Katwa, Gheria and Udaynala.
- **Patna Massacre (1763):** about 200 British prisoners killed on Mir Qasim's orders by Walter Reinhardt (Sumru) (Anantam IAS).
- **Battle of Buxar (22–23 October 1764):** Major **Hector Munro** (about 7,000 troops) defeated the alliance of **Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daulah (Awadh) and Shah Alam II** (about 40,000) on the Ganga, about 130 km west of Patna (Wikipedia).
- Just before Buxar, Bengal sepoys mutinied at **Manjhi** over pay arrears.
- After Mir Jafar's death (1765), his son **Najm-ud-Daulah** became Nawab.

Plassey vs Buxar (frequently asked)

Point	Plassey (1757)	Buxar (1764)
British commander	Robert Clive	Hector Munro
Opponent	Siraj-ud-Daulah alone	Triple alliance: Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daulah, Shah Alam II
How won	Treachery and conspiracy	Genuine military victory
Result	Puppet Nawab (Mir Jafar); political control	Treaty of Allahabad; Diwani; Company recognised as a major power in north India

Harry Verelst (1767–1769)

- Governor during the **First Anglo-Mysore War (1767–69)**, fought by Madras against Haidar Ali; ended by the **Treaty of Madras (1769)**, a mutual defensive pact that favoured Haidar.
- Continued the Dual Government; appointed English **supervisors** (1769) to oversee revenue collection.

John Cartier (1769–1772)

- Governor during the **Great Bengal Famine of 1769–70**, which killed an estimated one-third of the population (often given as about 10 million) (Wikipedia: John Cartier, Banglapedia).
- Revenue collection continued harshly during the famine; the disaster exposed the abuses of the Dual Government.
- The famine, plus the Company's near-bankruptcy, led Parliament to pass the **Regulating Act of 1773**.
- Cartier was succeeded by **Warren Hastings** in 1772.

Memory hook — "Van, Vere, Cart" (three vehicles in a row)

- **Van**sittart drives the **Van** to **Buxar** carrying Mir Qasim (1764).
- **Vere**lst = "**Ver**sus Haidar" — First Mysore War (1767–69).
- **Cart**ier = **carts** of the dead in the famine (1770).

Linkage: Dastak misuse → Mir Qasim abolishes all duties → war → Patna massacre → Buxar → Allahabad. Dual Government's greed → famine → Company bankrupt → Parliament steps in (Regulating Act).

3. Warren Hastings (Governor 1772–74; Governor-General 1774–1785)

Hastings ended the Dual Government and built the first British administrative machinery in Bengal. He was the last Governor of Bengal and, under the Regulating Act, the **first Governor-General of Bengal** (Vajiram & Ravi, Vision IAS revision module).

Administrative and revenue reforms

- **Abolished the Dual Government (1772)**; the Company took direct charge of revenue through its own servants.
- Shifted the **treasury and capital functions from Murshidabad to Calcutta**; removed the Indian deputy diwans (Muhammad Reza Khan, Shitab Rai).
- Set up a **Board of Revenue** at Calcutta (1772); divided Bengal into districts and appointed **Collectors**.
- **Quinquennial (five-year) settlement, 1772:** land revenue farmed out to the highest bidders for five years; it failed, as bidders over-promised.
- **Annual settlement, 1777**, returned to yearly leases; the **Amini Commission (1776)** surveyed revenue resources.
- Reduced the Nawab's allowance from Rs 32 lakh to Rs 16 lakh; stopped the Rs 26 lakh tribute to Shah Alam II and took back Kara and Allahabad (sold to Awadh).
- **Ring-fence policy:** protect the Company's frontiers by defending neighbours' frontiers (Awadh as a buffer against Marathas and Afghans).

Judicial reforms (1772 Judicial Plan)

- Removed the judicial powers of zamindars.

- Each district got a **Diwani Adalat** (civil; presided by the Collector; Hindu law for Hindus, Muslim law for Muslims) and a **Faujdari Adalat** (criminal; Indian officers with qazis and muftis, under Collector's supervision).
- Appeals: **Sadar Diwani Adalat** at Calcutta (civil, President and two Council members) and **Sadar Nizamat Adalat** (criminal, under an Indian deputy nazim with chief qazi and mufti; at Murshidabad).
- **Code of Gentoo Laws (1776):** Hindu law compiled in Sanskrit and translated into English by N.B. Halhed. Muslim law (Fatawa-i-Alamgiri) also translated.
- **Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)** under the Regulating Act; Chief Justice **Sir Elijah Impey**. Its jurisdiction clashed with the Council's, which the **Act of Settlement, 1781** resolved.

Trade reforms (1775)

- Abolished the misused **dastaks** and restricted private trade by Company servants.
- Reduced the number of customs houses and fixed a **uniform 2.5% duty** for Indian and non-Indian goods.

Education and culture

- **Calcutta Madrasa (1781)** — founded by Hastings (UPSC 2018 PYQ: Calcutta Madrasa–Warren Hastings is the correct pair; Sanskrit College Benaras was Jonathan Duncan; Fort William College was Richard, not Arthur, Wellesley).
- **Asiatic Society of Bengal (1784)** founded by **Sir William Jones**, under Hastings' patronage.
- Charles Wilkins' English translation of the **Bhagavad Gita (1785)**, with a preface by Hastings.
- **Hicky's Bengal Gazette (1780)**, James Augustus Hicky — the first newspaper in India.

Acts passed in his time

- **Regulating Act, 1773:** GG of Bengal with a council of four (Philip Francis, Clavering, Monson, Barwell); Hastings had only one vote

plus a casting vote, so the Francis group often overruled him. Madras and Bombay subordinated in matters of war and peace.

- **Act of Settlement, 1781.**
- **Pitt's India Act, 1784:** Board of Control (6 members) for political affairs; Court of Directors kept commerce; council reduced to three. Called the system of "dual control".

Wars and diplomacy

Event	Years	Key facts
Rohilla War	1774	Company brigade lent to Nawab Shuja-ud-Daulah of Awadh against the Rohillas under the **Treaty of Banaras (1773)**; Rohilkhand annexed to Awadh; a charge in his impeachment
First Anglo-Maratha War	1775–82	Bombay backed Raghunath Rao (**Treaty of Surat, 1775**); Calcutta's **Treaty of Purandar (1776)**; British humiliated at **Wadgaon (1779)**; ended by the **Treaty of Salbai (1782)** with Mahadji Scindia's mediation; Salsette kept by the British; status quo otherwise; 20 years of peace with the Marathas
Second Anglo-Mysore War	1780–84	Haidar Ali (with Nizam and Marathas) defeated Col. Baillie (1780); Eyre Coote won at **Porto Novo (1781)**; Haidar died 1782; Tipu continued; ended by the **Treaty of Mangalore (1784)**, mutual restoration of conquests
Chait Singh affair	1781	Raja of Banaras fined and deposed for not paying extra war contributions
Begums of Awadh	1782	Mother and grandmother of the Nawab pressured to give up their treasure and jagirs

Nanda Kumar case (1775)

Maharaja Nanda Kumar accused Hastings of taking bribes. He was then tried for forgery and **hanged in 1775** after a trial by Impey's Supreme Court. Critics called it a "judicial murder".

Impeachment (1787–1795)

- After returning in 1785, Hastings was impeached by Parliament on charges led by **Edmund Burke** (with Sheridan and Fox): the Rohilla War, Nanda Kumar, Chait Singh, Begums of Awadh, corruption.
- The trial ran from 1788 to 1795; he was **acquitted in 1795**. He is the only Governor-General impeached.

UPSC angle: Mains often asks for his administrative, judicial and revenue reforms ("Give an account of the reforms of Warren Hastings"). Prelims likes Asiatic Society, Calcutta Madrasa, Salbai and Mangalore.

Memory hooks — Warren Hastings

- **Wars = "RoMaMy"** (say "Roma-me"): **Ro**hilla (1774), **Ma**ratha-I (1775–82), **My**sore-II (1780–84).
- **Treaties: S before M**, in both alphabet and date — **S**albai 1782 (Maratha), **M**angalore 1784 (Mysore).
- **Culture in date order = "Hicky Made Asia's Gita"**: Hicky's Gazette 1780 → Madrasa 1781 → Asiatic Society 1784 → Gita translation 1785.
- **Acts = "Regulate, Settle, Pitt"** (1773, 1781, 1784) — like a cook: regulate the fire, let it settle, put it in the pit.
- **Impeachment = "4 Cs and a K"**: Chait Singh, Crushing the Rohillas, Coercing the Begums, Corruption, and Nanda **K**umar. Prosecutor **B**urke **B**urned him, but he was acquitted (1795).
- **Number hook "72 → 85"**: came when Dual Government died (1772); left a year after Pitt's Act (1785).

Linkage: Regulating Act gave him a hostile council (Francis) → Nanda Kumar accused him → hanged by Impey's new Supreme Court → Court–Council clash → Act of Settlement 1781 → still messy → Pitt's India Act 1784 → Act of 1786 gives the next GG (Cornwallis) power to override his council.

4. Sir John Macpherson (1785–86, acting) and Lord Cornwallis (1786–1793)

Cornwallis gave British India its permanent machinery: the Permanent Settlement, the Cornwallis Code, a police system and a professional civil service. He is called the **"Father of the Civil Services in India"** (Vajiram & Ravi, GKToday).

- **Macpherson** only held charge for about 20 months between Hastings and Cornwallis; nothing major is asked.
- Cornwallis came with extra power: the **Act of 1786** let the GG **override his council** and also be **Commander-in-Chief**. He had earlier surrendered to the Americans at **Yorktown (1781)**.

Revenue: Permanent Settlement (22 March 1793)

- Introduced in **Bengal, Bihar and Orissa** (later extended to Varanasi and parts of Madras).
- **Decennial (ten-year) settlement of 1789–90** was declared permanent in 1793.
- Zamindars recognised as **owners of land** with hereditary, transferable rights; ryots became tenants.
- Revenue fixed for ever: **10/11 to the Company, 1/11 to the zamindar**.
- **Sunset Law:** if revenue was not paid by sunset on the due date, the estate was auctioned.
- Prepared largely with **Sir John Shore** (who preferred ten years) and James Grant; Pitt and the Directors approved making it permanent.
- Effects: fixed income for the Company and a loyal zamindar class; but rack-renting of peasants, absentee landlords, subinfeudation, and loss of future revenue for the state.

Judicial reforms: Cornwallis Code (1 May 1793)

- About **48 regulations**, drafted largely by Sir George Barlow (Banglapedia).

- **Separated revenue from justice:** the Collector lost judicial and magisterial powers; the post of **District Judge** was created.
- Hierarchy: District Diwani Adalat (District Judge) → **four Provincial Courts of Appeal** (Calcutta, Dacca, Murshidabad, Patna) → Sadar Diwani Adalat → King-in-Council (above Rs 5,000).
- Criminal: four **Courts of Circuit** with European judges; **Sadar Nizamat Adalat** moved from Murshidabad to **Calcutta** (1790) under the GG and council.
- Principle of **sovereignty of law**; Europeans also subject to civil courts; officials answerable for official acts.
- Court fees abolished; lawyers (vakils) recognised.

Police reforms

- Zamindars lost their police duties.
- Districts divided into **thanas** (circles of about 20 sq miles), each under an Indian **daroga**, supervised by the District Judge/Magistrate. Marshman later called the daroga the "scourge of the country".

Civil service reforms

- Raised salaries and strictly banned private trade and gifts.
- Promotion by **seniority**.
- **Europeanisation:** Indians excluded from higher posts (above about £500 a year).
- In 1789 he declared that practising slavery would face legal consequences.

Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790–1792)

- Cause: Tipu attacked **Travancore** (a British ally) in 1789.
- Cornwallis formed a **Triple Alliance** with the Nizam and the Marathas (1790) and personally besieged Seringapatam.
- **Treaty of Seringapatam (1792):** Tipu ceded **half his kingdom** (Malabar, Dindigul, Coorg area, Baramahal); paid about Rs 3 crore; gave **two sons as hostages** (Rau's IAS).

- He stayed neutral in the earlier Maratha–Mysore war (1785–87, Treaty of Gajendragarh).

Second term (1805)

Returned in 1805 to stop Wellesley's wars, but **died at Ghazipur** in October 1805 within months.

> **Memory hook — "Cornwallis the PC-PC man"**
>
> - **P**ermanent Settlement · **C**ornwallis Code · **P**olice (daroga) · **C**ivil service. All of it peaks in **1793**: "**93 = Code and Zamindar**".
> - "Lost America at Yorktown, won Bengal on paper."
> - Third Mysore War: **"Tipu cut in half"** — the **third** war took **half** his kingdom and **two** sons.
> - Revenue split: **"10 for the King, 1 for the Zamindar"** (10/11 : 1/11).
> - Sunset Law: **"Pay by sunset or lose the estate."**

Linkage: Hastings' five-year and annual auctions failed → Pitt's Act ordered a permanent arrangement → Shore's surveys → Decennial 1790 → Permanent 1793. Collector-judge conflicts → separation of powers in the Code. Seringapatam weakened Tipu → Wellesley finished him in 1799.

5. Sir John Shore (1793–1798)

Shore followed a strict **policy of non-intervention**, as directed by Parliament, and is remembered for the Charter Act of 1793 and the Battle of Kharda (GKToday, Wikipedia).

- A Company civil servant and revenue expert; main architect of the surveys behind the **Permanent Settlement**.
- **Charter Act, 1793:** Company's trade monopoly renewed for **20 years**; the GG's power to **override his council** extended to future GGs; the GG's control over Madras and Bombay strengthened; salaries of the Board of Control to be paid from **Indian revenues**.

- **Battle of Kharda (11 March 1795):** the Marathas defeated the **Nizam of Hyderabad**. Shore refused to help the Nizam, so British prestige fell. It was the **last time all Maratha chiefs fought together** (under Parshuram Bhau Patwardhan).
- **Awadh exception (1797–98):** Shore intervened in the Awadh succession, deposed **Wazir Ali** and made **Saadat Ali Khan** Nawab.
- His neutrality let French influence grow at Hyderabad and with Tipu; Wellesley reversed the policy.

> **Memory hook — "Shore stays on the shore"**
>
> - He never jumps into the water (non-intervention), so he watched the Nizam **drown at Kharda** (1795).
> - **"Three 93s":** Cornwallis' Code (1793), Permanent Settlement (1793), Charter Act (1793) — and Shore arrives in 1793.
> - Only splash: Awadh — "**W**azir out, **S**aadat in".

Linkage: Non-intervention → Nizam abandoned at Kharda → Nizam hires French officers (Raymond) → Wellesley fears French → Nizam becomes the **first Subsidiary Alliance** state (1798).

6. Lord Wellesley (1798–1805)

Wellesley ended non-intervention and made the Company the paramount power, chiefly through the **Subsidiary Alliance**, the destruction of Tipu and the Second Maratha War. He called himself the **"Bengal Tiger"** (GKToday, Vajiram & Ravi).

Context: Napoleon was in Egypt (1798); Tipu, the Nizam and Scindia employed French officers. Wellesley feared a French-backed attack on India.

Subsidiary Alliance (from 1798)

The idea of hiring out European troops came from **Dupleix**; Wellesley made it a system.

Terms for the Indian ruler

- Accept a permanent British force in his state and pay for it (cash or ceded territory).
- Keep a British **Resident** at his court.
- Expel all non-British Europeans (especially the French).
- No war or negotiations with other states without British consent.
- In return, the Company protected him and promised not to interfere in internal affairs (often broken).

State	Year	Notes
Hyderabad (Nizam)	1798 (and 1800)	**First** to sign; in 1800 ceded territories got from Mysore = the "Ceded Districts"
Mysore	1799	After Tipu's death; Wodeyar ruler Krishnaraja III
Tanjore	1799	Serfoji II gave up administration
Awadh	1801	Ceded **Rohilkhand and the Lower Doab**
Peshwa	1802	**Treaty of Bassein** (31 Dec 1802)
Bhonsle (Nagpur)	1803	Treaty of Deogaon
Scindia (Gwalior)	1803	Treaty of Surji-Anjangaon
Holkar (Indore)	1818	Treaty of Mandasor, under Lord Hastings
Rajput states	1818	Under Lord Hastings

Effects: Indian states lost independence, disbanded armies (unemployed soldiers became **Pindaris**), and misrule grew because rulers were protected from their own people.

Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)

- Tipu refused the Subsidiary Alliance and sought French help.
- Generals Harris, Stuart and **Arthur Wellesley** (Wellesley's younger brother, later victor of Waterloo) attacked.
- **Tipu died defending Seringapatam on 4 May 1799**.

- Kanara, Coimbatore and Wynad annexed; core Mysore restored to the Wodeyars under a Subsidiary Alliance.

Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803–1805)

- Holkar defeated the Peshwa and Scindia at Poona (1802); **Baji Rao II** fled and signed the **Treaty of Bassein**. Scindia and Bhonsle saw this as surrender of Maratha independence.
- Arthur Wellesley won at **Assaye and Argaon** (1803); General **Lake** won at **Laswari and Delhi** (1803), taking Shah Alam II under British protection.
- Treaties: **Deogaon** (Bhonsle, Dec 1803; Cuttack and Balasore ceded), **Surji-Anjangaon** (Scindia, Dec 1803), **Rajghat** (Holkar, 1805, under Barlow).
- Lake failed to take **Bharatpur** (1805).

Annexations and administration

- Took over **Tanjore (1799), Surat (1800), Carnatic (1801)**; **Madras Presidency** formed in 1801.
- **Fort William College, Calcutta (10 July 1800)** to train civil servants (Carey, Gilchrist, Colebrooke taught). The Directors shifted training to **Haileybury, England (1806)**.
- **Censorship of the Press Act, 1799:** newspapers had to print the names of printer, editor and owner and submit material to the government before publishing.
- Company debt rose from about £10 million to £21 million; the Directors recalled him (1805).

Memory hooks — Wellesley

- **"The Bengal Tiger killed the Tiger of Mysore"** (Tipu, 1799).
- **Subsidiary order = "HMT Awards Prizes to Bhonsle and Scindia"**: **H**yderabad 1798, **M**ysore 1799, **T**anjore 1799, **A**wadh 1801, **P**eshwa 1802, **B**honsle 1803, **S**cindia 1803. (Think of an HMT watch given as an award.)
- **Wellesley's "4 F" kit: F**ort William College (1800), **F**ourth Mysore War (1799), **F**eudatories through Subsidiary Alliance,

Free press gagged (1799 Act).

- **2nd Maratha treaties = "D-S-R" = "Do Some Rest"**: Deogaon (Bhonsle), Surji-Anjangaon (Scindia), Rajghat (Holkar).
- **Two Wellesleys:** Richard = Governor-General (college). Arthur = soldier (Assaye, later Waterloo). UPSC 2018 tested this.

Linkage: French scare (Napoleon in Egypt) → Subsidiary Alliance → Tipu refuses → Fourth Mysore War → Tipu's family imprisoned at **Vellore** → Vellore Mutiny (1806). Bassein → Second Maratha War. Armies disbanded under the alliance → jobless soldiers join **Pindaris** → Lord Hastings' Pindari War (1817). Huge debts → recall → Cornwallis sent back to make peace.

7. Cornwallis again (1805) and Sir George Barlow (1805–1807)

After Cornwallis died at Ghazipur (October 1805), **Sir George Barlow** (drafter of the Cornwallis Code) acted as GG and returned to non-intervention (GKToday on Vellore).

- **Treaty of Rajghat (1805)** with Yashwantrao Holkar ended the Second Anglo-Maratha War.
- **Vellore Mutiny (10 July 1806):** the first large-scale sepoy revolt, at Vellore Fort near Madras.
- Cause: Commander-in-Chief **Sir John Cradock**'s new dress code (Nov 1805): no caste marks on the forehead, beards shaved, earrings banned, and a round hat with a **leather cockade** instead of the turban.
- **Tipu Sultan's sons**, imprisoned in the fort since 1799, were linked to the plot; a daughter's wedding (9 July) gathered people in the fort.
- Sepoys attacked the British 69th Regiment; **Col. Robert Rollo Gillespie** crushed the revolt within hours from Arcot.

- Result: Madras Governor **Lord William Bentinck** and Cradock were **recalled**; the dress orders withdrawn; Tipu's family moved to Calcutta.

Memory hook — "Barlow barricades Vellore"

- **Hat, not turban** → revolt. Think "**V**ellore = **V**ery angry over a **v**ile hat".
- **The Vellore–Bentinck loop:** Bentinck was **sacked** as Madras Governor for Vellore (1806), but **came back** as Governor-General in 1828 and became a great reformer. Disgrace to glory in 22 years.

Linkage: Fourth Mysore War (1799) put Tipu's sons in Vellore → dress code (1805) → mutiny (1806) → Bentinck recalled → Bentinck returns (1828). Religion-and-dress grievances also link forward to the greased cartridges of 1857.

8. Lord Minto I (1807–1813)

Minto's tenure was about blocking a feared **Franco-Russian invasion** (after the Treaty of Tilsit, 1807) through diplomacy, and it ended with the **Charter Act of 1813** (GKToday, Wikipedia).

Four diplomatic missions

Envoy	Sent to	Result
Charles Metcalfe (aged 23)	Lahore — Ranjit Singh	**Treaty of Amritsar, 25 April 1809**
John Malcolm	Persia	Persian cooperation against the French (Harford Jones' Treaty of Tehran, 1809)
Mountstuart Elphinstone	Kabul — Shah Shuja	Promise to resist the French
Nicholas Smith	Sindh	Friendship treaty

Treaty of Amritsar (1809)

- The **Sutlej** fixed as the boundary of Ranjit Singh's kingdom; he could not expand east of it.
- The **cis-Sutlej states** came under British protection (Ochterlony's proclamation, 1809).
- Ranjit Singh kept the treaty for the rest of his life; also called the **Minto–Metcalfe Treaty**.

Other events

- Captured French and Dutch islands: **Mauritius (1810)**, **Java (1811)**, where Stamford Raffles became Lieutenant-Governor.
- Subdued Bundelkhand forts (Ajaygarh, Kalinjar); restrained the Pindari leader Amir Khan in Berar.

Charter Act, 1813

- Company's charter renewed for **20 years**.
- **Trade monopoly with India ended**, except the trade in **tea and trade with China**.
- **Rs 1 lakh a year** for the revival of literature and the promotion of science among Indians — the first state commitment to education.
- **Christian missionaries** allowed to come to India (with licences).
- Local governments allowed to tax Europeans; Board of Control's authority confirmed.

Memory hooks — Minto I

- **"Minto mints a 1-lakh coin"** for education (1813) and draws a line on the **Sutlej**.
- **Envoys = "Me-El-Ma"**, nearest to farthest (east to west): **Me**tcalfe to Lahore, **El**phinstone to Kabul, **Ma**lcolm to Persia.
- **"1809 = Lion stopped by the river"** — Ranjit Singh, the Lion of Punjab, halted at the Sutlej.
- **Charter Act 1813 = "T-M-L" ("Tea, Missionaries, Lakh")**: monopoly ends except **T**ea/China, **M**issionaries enter, 1 **L**akh for education.

Linkage: Napoleon's Tilsit pact → fear of overland invasion → missions → Treaty of Amritsar keeps Punjab friendly until Ranjit's death (1839) → after 1839, Punjab collapses → Anglo-Sikh wars → Dalhousie annexes Punjab (1849). The 1813 education grant → Orientalist–Anglicist debate → Macaulay's Minute (1835).

9. Lord Hastings / Lord Moira (1813–1823)

Lord Hastings (Francis Rawdon-Hastings, Earl of Moira) abandoned non-intervention for a **policy of intervention and war (Paramountcy)**: he defeated the Gurkhas, wiped out the Pindaris and ended the Maratha Confederacy (GKToday, Vision IAS). Do not confuse him with Warren Hastings.

Anglo-Nepal (Gurkha) War, 1814–1816

- General **David Ochterlony** led the campaign.
- **Treaty of Sugauli (1816):** Nepal ceded **Garhwal and Kumaon** and most of the Terai; accepted a British **Resident at Kathmandu**; withdrew from Sikkim.
- British gained the sites of **Shimla, Mussoorie, Nainital, Ranikhet** hill stations; Gurkhas began to be recruited into the British army.
- Moira was made **Marquess of Hastings** (1816) for this war.

Pindari War (1817–1818)

- Pindaris were irregular horsemen once attached to Maratha armies; many were soldiers made jobless by the Subsidiary Alliance.
- Leaders: **Chitu, Wasil Muhammad, Karim Khan**, and Amir Khan, who was made **Nawab of Tonk**.
- Hastings gathered about 120,000 troops and crushed them by 1818.

Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817–1818/19)

Maratha chief	Defeated at	Treaty
Peshwa Baji Rao II	**Khadki/Kirkee** (Nov 1817), **Koregaon** (1 Jan 1818), Ashti (1818)	**Treaty of Poona** (June 1817), surrendered June 1818
Bhonsle (Appa Sahib)	**Sitabuldi** (Nov 1817)	—
Holkar (Malhar Rao II)	**Mahidpur** (Dec 1817)	**Treaty of Mandasor** (Jan 1818)
Scindia	No battle	**Treaty of Gwalior** (Nov 1817)

- **Peshwaship abolished**; Baji Rao II pensioned off to **Bithur** near Kanpur (his adopted son was **Nana Saheb**).
- A small kingdom of **Satara** created for Shivaji's descendant Pratap Singh.
- **Bombay Presidency** created (1818); Rajput states accepted British protection (1818).

Administration and society

- **Ryotwari System** in Madras by **Thomas Munro** (1820); **Mahalwari System** in the North-West Provinces by Holt Mackenzie (Regulation VII of 1822).
- **Hindu College, Calcutta (1817)**, with David Hare and Rammohan Roy's supporters.
- Relaxed press censorship (1818); Indian-language newspapers began to appear.
- After him, **John Adam** (acting GG, 1823) imposed the **Licensing Regulation, 1823** on the press.

Memory hooks — Lord Hastings

- **"Hastings-II fought G-P-M"** = **G**urkhas (1814), **P**indaris (1817), **M**arathas (1817) — "**G**ood **P**olice **M**an".

- **Sugauli = "Sugar Hills"**: Nepal gave the sweet hill stations (Shimla, Mussoorie, Nainital).
- **Third Maratha battles = "Kirkee Kicked, Sita Sat, Mahi Made peace"**: Kirkee/Koregaon (Peshwa), Sitabuldi (Bhonsle), Mahidpur (Holkar).
- **Treaties = "P-G-M" ("Poona Gave Mandasor")**: Poona (Peshwa), Gwalior (Scindia), Mandasor (Holkar).
- **Revenue "Ryot in the South, Mahal in the North"**: Munro's Ryotwari (Madras, 1820), Mackenzie's Mahalwari (1822).

Linkage: Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance disbanded armies → jobless soldiers became Pindaris → chasing Pindaris through Maratha lands → Third Maratha War → Peshwa sent to Bithur → his adopted son **Nana Saheb** loses the pension under **Dalhousie** → leads the revolt at Kanpur in **1857**.

10. Lord Amherst (1823–1828)

Amherst's tenure is the **First Anglo-Burmese War** and the **Barrackpore Mutiny** (GKToday, Wikipedia).

First Anglo-Burmese War (1824–1826)

- Cause: Burma's expansion into **Assam, Manipur, Cachar and Jaintia**, on Bengal's border. War declared on 5 March 1824.
- Sir Archibald Campbell captured Rangoon; the war was long and costly (about £13 million).
- **Treaty of Yandabo (24 February 1826):** Burma ceded **Arakan and Tenasserim**; gave up claims on **Assam, Cachar, Jaintia**; recognised **Manipur** as independent; paid an indemnity of about Rs 1 crore; accepted a British Resident at Ava.
- Amherst became **Earl Amherst of Arracan**. Assam's annexation later helped the tea industry.

Barrackpore Mutiny (2 November 1824)

- The **47th Bengal Native Infantry** at Barrackpore refused to go to Burma, partly because crossing the sea ("kala pani") broke

caste rules, and because they were not given allowances for bullocks and supplies.

- Led by sepoy **Bindee Tiwari**; the regiment was fired upon with artillery and disbanded.
- Britannica calls it a "dress rehearsal" for 1857.

Other events

- **Capture of Bharatpur (1826)** by Lord Combermere — the fort that Lake had failed to take in 1805.
- **Sanskrit College, Calcutta (1824).**

Memory hooks — Amherst

- **"Am-BURST into BURMA"**.
- **Yandabo = "MAAT" gained**: **M**anipur, **A**ssam, **A**rakan, **T**enasserim.
- **"Barrackpore twice"**: 1824 sepoys refused to cross the sea to Burma; **1857** Mangal Pandey fired at the same Barrackpore. Same place, same caste fear.
- **Bharatpur revenge:** "Lake lost it (1805), Amherst got it (1826)."

Linkage: Burmese expansion into Assam → war → sea journey fear → Barrackpore 1824 → General Service Enlistment Act 1856 (Canning) forcing overseas service → 1857. Unfinished Burma business → Second Burmese War under Dalhousie (1852).

11. Lord William Bentinck (1828–1835): first Governor-General of India

Bentinck was GG of Bengal from 1828 and, under the **Charter Act of 1833**, became the **first Governor-General of India**. His era is the age of liberal reform: sati, thuggee and English education (GKToday, Vajiram & Ravi). He is called the most liberal GG and the "father of modern Western education in India".

Social reforms

- **Abolition of Sati — Regulation XVII, 4 December 1829** (Bengal): abetting sati made culpable homicide; extended to Madras and Bombay in 1830. Raja **Rammohan Roy** campaigned for it; the orthodox **Dharma Sabha** appealed to the Privy Council and lost.
- **Suppression of Thuggee (from 1830):** Captain **William Henry Sleeman** ("Thuggee Sleeman") broke the network of ritual stranglers; a Thuggee and Dacoity Department was set up.
- Measures against **female infanticide** and child sacrifice (Saugar Island).

Education

- **Macaulay's Minute (2 February 1835)** sided with the **Anglicists** over the Orientalists.
- **English Education Act / Resolution of 7 March 1835:** government funds to go to Western learning through **English**; English replaced **Persian** as the language of higher courts and government.
- **Calcutta Medical College (1835).**

Administrative, judicial and revenue reforms

- Abolished Cornwallis' **Provincial Courts of Appeal and Circuit**; created **Commissioners of Revenue and Circuit**.
- Separate Sadar Diwani and Nizamat Adalat at **Allahabad** for the upper provinces.
- Reversed Cornwallis' exclusion: Indians appointed as **Deputy Collectors, Deputy Magistrates, Sadar Amins**; vernacular languages in lower courts.
- **Mahalwari settlement** in the North-West Provinces put on a firm basis (Regulation IX of 1833, R.M. Bird).
- Cut expenditure (half-batta for officers) to restore Company finances.

Charter Act, 1833

- GG of Bengal became **GG of India**, with full civil, military and legislative powers over all British India; Madras and Bombay lost their legislative powers.
- Company's **commercial activities ended** entirely; it became a purely administrative body.
- A **Law Member** (Macaulay) added to the council; first **Law Commission** set up under Macaulay.
- **Section 87:** no Indian to be barred from office because of religion, birthplace, descent or colour.
- Directed the government to take steps to end slavery.

Annexations and diplomacy

- **Mysore (1831)** taken over for misrule (restored in 1881); **Coorg (1834)**; **Central Cachar (1834)**; **Jaintia (1835)**.
- Treaty of "perpetual friendship" with **Ranjit Singh** at Ropar (1831); commercial treaty with the **Amirs of Sindh (1832)** opening the Indus.

Memory hooks — Bentinck: "one big event every year, 1829 to 1835"

- **29** Sati → **30** Thugs → **31** Mysore and Ranjit Singh → **32** Sindh treaty → **33** Charter Act (GG of India) → **34** Coorg → **35** English Education Act and Medical College.
- **"Bentinck SETs India right"** = **S**ati, **E**nglish education, **T**huggee.
- **Redemption story:** sacked as Madras Governor after **Vellore (1806)**, returned 22 years later as the great reformer.
- **"Ram + Bentinck vs Sati"**: Rammohan Roy's campaign + Bentinck's law.

Linkage: Charter Act 1813's Rs 1 lakh → Orientalist–Anglicist debate → Macaulay's Minute → English Education Act 1835 → Wood's Despatch 1854 (Dalhousie) → universities of 1857. Section 87 of 1833 → open competition in Charter Act 1853 → ICS exams. Sindh

treaty of 1832 → broken during the Afghan War → Sindh annexed 1843.

12. Sir Charles Metcalfe (1835–36, acting) and Lord Auckland (1836–1842)

Sir Charles Metcalfe — "Liberator of the Indian Press"

- **Press Act of 1835 (Metcalfe Act)** repealed John Adam's **Licensing Regulation of 1823**; printers only had to make a simple declaration of their premises (GKToday).
- The 1823 rules had forced Rammohan Roy to close his Persian weekly **Mirat-ul-Akbar**.
- The Directors disliked the liberal Act, so Metcalfe was not made permanent GG.
- **Calcutta Public Library** opened in March 1836, later housed in Metcalfe Hall; it is an ancestor of today's National Library.
- The same Metcalfe, aged 23, had negotiated the **Treaty of Amritsar (1809)** with Ranjit Singh.

Press laws timeline (asked often): Censorship Act 1799 (Wellesley) → Licensing Regulation 1823 (John Adam) → Press Act 1835 (Metcalfe, liberal) → Licensing Act 1857 (Canning) → Vernacular Press Act 1878 (Lytton).

Lord Auckland — First Anglo-Afghan War (1838–1842)

- Context: the **"Great Game"** with Russia. Afghan Amir **Dost Mohammad** received a Russian envoy (Vitkevich); Auckland adopted a **Forward Policy** (GKToday).
- **Tripartite Treaty (26 June 1838)**: British + **Ranjit Singh** + **Shah Shuja**, to put Shah Shuja on the Kabul throne.
- **Simla Manifesto (1 October 1838)** declared war; the **Army of the Indus** marched through **Sindh**, breaking the 1832 treaty with the Amirs.
- Kabul taken and Shah Shuja installed (1839), but Afghans revolted (1841): Alexander Burnes and William Macnaghten were killed.

- **Retreat from Kabul (January 1842):** almost the whole force was destroyed; Dr William Brydon famously reached Jalalabad. Biggest blow to British prestige before 1857.
- **Ranjit Singh died in 1839**, during this war.
- Other: forced a subsidiary treaty on Sindh (1839); **Bank of Bombay (1840)**; famine in Agra region (1837–38).

Memory hooks

- **"Metcalfe Met the press and freed it"** — 1835 cancels 1823.
- **Metcalfe's two hats:** envoy at Amritsar (1809) → Governor-General (1835).
- **"Auckland's Afghan Agony"** (A-A-A). Tripartite = **"Sahibs, Sikhs and Shuja"**.
- **"1-2-3 of the Afghan war"**: 18**38** start, 18**39** Ranjit dies, 18**42** retreat.

Linkage: Russia fear → Tripartite Treaty → army marches through Sindh (treaty broken) → Afghan disaster → British need a win and the Indus route → **Sindh annexed (1843)**. Ranjit Singh's death (1839) → chaos in Punjab → Sikh wars.

13. Lord Ellenborough (1842–1844) and Lord Hardinge I (1844–1848)

Lord Ellenborough

- Ended the Afghan War: Generals **Pollock and Nott** reoccupied Kabul (1842) and then withdrew (GKToday).
- **Annexation of Sindh (August 1843):** Sir **Charles Napier** defeated the Amirs at **Miani** and **Dabo (Hyderabad)** in 1843 and became Sindh's first Governor. The famous one-word message "Peccavi" ("I have sinned") is a later Punch magazine pun.
- **Indian Slavery Act, 1843 (Act V of 1843, 7 April 1843):** slavery abolished in British India, without compensation to owners.

- **Gwalior War (1843):** battles of **Maharajpur and Panniar**, both on 29 December 1843.
- Recalled by the Directors in 1844.

Lord Hardinge I — First Anglo-Sikh War (1845–1846)

- After Ranjit Singh's death, the Khalsa army dominated Lahore. It crossed the Sutlej on 11 December 1845; Hardinge declared war on 13 December (GKToday).
- Treachery of Sikh commanders **Lal Singh and Tej Singh** helped the British.

Battle	Date	Result
Mudki	18 Dec 1845	British
Ferozeshah	21–22 Dec 1845	British (nearly lost)
Baddowal	21 Jan 1846	Sikh
Aliwal	28 Jan 1846	British (Harry Smith)
Sobraon	10 Feb 1846	British, decisive (Hugh Gough)

Three treaties of 1846

Treaty	Date	Terms
Lahore	9 March 1846	**Jalandhar Doab** (Beas–Sutlej) ceded; war indemnity; Sikh army reduced; Dalip Singh Maharaja with Rani Jindan as regent; British Resident (Henry Lawrence) at Lahore
Amritsar	16 March 1846	**Kashmir sold to Gulab Singh** (Dogra ruler of Jammu) for **Rs 75 lakh**
Bhairowal	16 December 1846	Rani Jindan removed; a **council of regency** of 8 sardars under the British Resident; British troops stationed at Lahore

Other measures: suppression of **female infanticide** and **human sacrifice** among the Gonds/Khonds; **Thomason Engineering College, Roorkee (1847)**; preference to **English-educated Indians** in government jobs.

Memory hooks

- **"Ellen took Sindh and freed the slaves — both in 1843."**
- **Sikh War I battles in order = "My Friend's Brother Always Sobers up"**: **M**udki, **F**erozeshah, **B**addowal, **A**liwal, **S**obraon.
- **1846 treaties = a "LAB"**: **L**ahore (March), **A**mritsar (March), **B**hairowal (December).
- **Trap: two Treaties of Amritsar. 1809** = Minto with **Ranjit Singh** (Sutlej boundary). **1846** = Hardinge with **Gulab Singh** (Kashmir sold).
- **"Hard-inge = Hard fight"** — Ferozeshah was nearly a British defeat.

Linkage: Sindh annexed → British border touches Punjab → Khalsa army alarmed → First Sikh War → Kashmir sold to Gulab Singh (origin of the princely state of Jammu and Kashmir) → Bhairowal makes Punjab a British protectorate → Multan revolt (1848) → Second Sikh War under Dalhousie → Punjab annexed (1849).

14. Lord Dalhousie (1848–1856)

Dalhousie (James Andrew Broun-Ramsay) was the greatest annexer and the great modernizer: he added Punjab, Lower Burma, the lapsed states and Awadh, and built the railway, telegraph and postal systems. Both sides of his work fed the **Revolt of 1857** (GKToday, Vision IAS).

Annexation by war

- **Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848–49):** began with the **Multan revolt** of Diwan **Mulraj** (April 1848); battles of **Ramnagar** (1848), **Chillianwala** (13 Jan 1849, very costly, near-draw) and **Gujrat** (21 Feb 1849, decisive). **Punjab annexed in March 1849**; the **Koh-i-noor** sent to Queen Victoria; Dalip Singh sent to England; Punjab run by a Board of Administration (the Lawrence brothers) (GKToday).
- **Second Anglo-Burmese War (1852): Lower Burma (Pegu)** annexed.

Doctrine of Lapse

If a dependent Hindu ruler died without a natural heir, his state "lapsed" to the Company; adopted sons could inherit private property but not the throne.

State	Year	Ruler / note
Satara	1848	**First** state annexed
Jaitpur	1849	Bundelkhand
Sambalpur	1849	Odisha
Baghat	1850	Later restored by Canning
Udaipur (Chhattisgarh, not Mewar)	1852	Later restored
Jhansi	1853–54	Raja Gangadhar Rao died Nov 1853; adopted son Damodar Rao refused; **Rani Lakshmibai**
Nagpur	1854	Raghuji III; the largest state lapsed

UPSC 2004 asked the order Satara → Sambalpur → Jhansi (Dalvoy).

Other annexations and abolitions

- **Berar (1853)** taken from the Nizam for unpaid subsidy arrears.
- **Awadh (February 1856)** annexed on grounds of **misgovernance** (James **Outram**'s report), not lapse — Nawab **Wajid Ali Shah** had heirs and was sent to Calcutta.
- Stopped titles and pensions: Nawab of Carnatic, Raja of Tanjore, and the pension of the former Peshwa's adopted son **Nana Saheb** (1851).

Modernisation

- **Railways:** Railway Minute (1853); first passenger train **Bombay to Thane, 16 April 1853**; Howrah–Hooghly line (1854); companies built lines under a guarantee system. Called the "father of Indian Railways".

- **Telegraph:** first line **Calcutta to Agra (1853–54)** under O'Shaughnessy; about 4,000 miles linked Calcutta with Bombay, Madras and Peshawar.
- **Post Office Act, 1854:** a Director-General of Posts; uniform **half-anna** rate regardless of distance; **postage stamps** introduced.
- **Public Works Department** in every province; **Ganges Canal** opened (1854); work on the Grand Trunk Road.
- **Wood's Despatch (1854)** by Charles Wood, President of the Board of Control — the **"Magna Carta of English Education in India"**: education departments in provinces, **universities at Calcutta, Bombay, Madras** on the London model (set up in 1857), grants-in-aid, vernacular primary schools, women's education and teacher training.
- **Charter Act, 1853:** separated **legislative from executive** functions of the council (a 12-member Legislative Council); **open competition** for the civil services (Macaulay Committee, 1854); charter not renewed for a fixed period; Bengal got its own Lieutenant-Governor.
- **Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act** (Act XV of 1856), championed by **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar**: prepared under Dalhousie, passed in **July 1856 under Canning**.
- Army headquarters moved to **Shimla**; Gurkha regiments expanded.
- **Santhal Rebellion (1855–56)** under **Sidhu and Kanhu**.

Memory hooks — Dalhousie

- **Lapse order = "Some Jolly Soldiers Bought Umbrellas in Jhansi and Nagpur"**: **S**atara, **J**aitpur, **S**ambalpur, **B**aghat, **U**daipur, **J**hansi, **N**agpur.
- **Annexed by war = "P-P"**: **P**unjab (1849) and **P**egu (1852). **By debt = Berar. By "misrule" = Awadh.**
- **"R-T-P" moderniser** (1853–54): **R**ail, **T**elegraph, **P**ost — all within one year. "Dal-house built the house of modern India."
- **"1853 = 3 lines"**: first railway line, first telegraph line, last Charter Act.

- **Wood's Despatch = "Wood is the Magna Carta"** — note: Charles Wood was not a Governor-General.
- **Trap:** the Widow Remarriage Act is often credited to Dalhousie, but it was passed under **Canning** (1856).

Linkage (to 1857): Lapse took **Jhansi** → Rani Lakshmibai rebels. Pension stopped → **Nana Saheb** rebels at Kanpur. Awadh annexed → Awadh sepoys (most of the Bengal Army) and taluqdars angry → Lucknow centre of revolt. Railways and telegraph → helped the British move troops and news to crush 1857. Punjab annexed and settled → Sikh regiments helped the British in 1857.

15. Governors of the other Presidencies and Lieutenant-Governors (1757–1856)

Besides the Governor of Bengal / Governor-General, the Company had **Governors at Madras (Fort St. George) and Bombay**, and from 1836 **Lieutenant-Governors** for the North-Western Provinces (Agra) and, from 1854, for Bengal. UPSC asks about these men mainly through land revenue, education and revolts, not as a list. After the **Regulating Act (1773)** the Madras and Bombay Governors were subordinate to the GG in matters of war and peace; the **Charter Act (1833)** took away their power to make laws.

Governors and Lieutenant-Governors who matter for UPSC

Name	Post and years	Served under (GG)	Why UPSC cares
William Hornby	Governor of Bombay, 1771–84	Warren Hastings	Bombay backed Raghunath Rao (**Treaty of Surat, 1775**) → started the First Anglo-Maratha War; Hornby Vellard causeway in Bombay

Name	Post and years	Served under (GG)	Why UPSC cares
Lord Macartney	Governor of Madras, 1781–85	Warren Hastings	Signed the **Treaty of Mangalore (1784)** with Tipu, ending the Second Mysore War
Jonathan Duncan	Resident at Benares 1788–95; Governor of Bombay 1795–1811	Cornwallis to Minto	Founded the **Sanskrit College, Benares (1791)**; suppressed **female infanticide** (Benares, and among the Jadejas of Kathiawar). UPSC 2018 PYQ: the Benares college was Duncan's, **not** William Jones' (Wikipedia)
Edward Clive (Lord Clive, son of Robert Clive)	Governor of Madras, 1798–1803	Wellesley	Madras during the **Fourth Mysore War** and the take-over of **Tanjore and the Carnatic**
Lord William Bentinck	Governor of Madras, 1803–07	Wellesley, Barlow	**Vellore Mutiny (1806)** → recalled; later GG (1828–35)
Mountstuart Elphinstone	Resident at Poona; Governor of Bombay, 1819–27	Lord Hastings, Amherst	Envoy to **Kabul (1808)**; fought the Peshwa at **Kirkee (1817)**; settled the conquered Peshwa lands; **Elphinstone Code (1827)**; promoted education (Elphinstone College named after him); wrote a *History of India*

Name	Post and years	Served under (GG)	Why UPSC cares
Sir Thomas Munro	Governor of Madras, 1820–27	Lord Hastings, Amherst	**Father of the Ryotwari System** (worked out with Alexander Read in Baramahal from 1792; formalised in Madras from 1820); pushed for Indians in administration; died of cholera on tour in 1827 (Wikipedia, Anantam IAS)
Sir John Malcolm	Governor of Bombay, 1827–30	Amherst, Bentinck	Envoy to **Persia** (1800s); settled Central India after the Pindari War
Sir Charles Metcalfe	First Lt-Governor of the North-Western Provinces, 1836–38	Auckland	Same Metcalfe of Amritsar 1809 and the Press Act 1835
James Thomason	Lt-Governor of the North-Western Provinces, 1843–53	Ellenborough, Hardinge, Dalhousie	Developed the **Mahalwari** settlement (after R.M. Bird); founded **Roorkee Engineering College (1847)**, now IIT Roorkee; promoted village vernacular schools (Wikipedia)
Sir Frederick Halliday	**First Lt-Governor of Bengal**, 1854	Dalhousie	Created under the **Charter Act 1853**, which freed the GG from governing Bengal directly (Banglapedia)

Land revenue systems and their architects (frequent UPSC theme)

System	Year	Area	Architect	Governor-General
Permanent Settlement (Zamindari)	1793	Bengal, Bihar, Orissa (later Varanasi, North Madras)	Cornwallis, with John Shore	Cornwallis
Ryotwari	1792 experiment; 1820 formal	Madras, later Bombay (Wingate–Goldsmid survey), Assam, Coorg	Alexander Read and **Thomas Munro**	Lord Hastings
Mahalwari	1822 (Regulation VII); revised 1833	North-Western Provinces, Central India, Punjab	**Holt Mackenzie**, then R.M. Bird and James Thomason	Lord Hastings, Bentinck

Memory hooks

- **Revenue = "Zamindar–Ryot–Mahal" = "Z-R-M"** in date order: 1793 → 1820 → 1822. Think "**Z**ero **R**upees **M**ade".
- **"Munro in Madras, Mackenzie in the Middle (north), Cornwallis in Calcutta"** — each man in his region.
- **"Duncan's Dharma"** — Duncan founded the **Sanskrit** college at Benares; **Hastings** the **Madrasa** at Calcutta; **Wellesley** the **Fort William** college. One college per name.
- **"Elphinstone everywhere"**: Kabul envoy (1808) → Poona Resident → Kirkee (1817) → Bombay Governor (1819) → historian.

- **Lt-Governors = "Met, Tom, Hall"**: **Met**calfe (first NWP, 1836), **Tho**mason (NWP, Roorkee), **Hal**liday (first Bengal, 1854).

Linkage: Regulating Act made Bombay and Madras subordinate → yet Bombay's Hornby started the First Maratha War on his own (Treaty of Surat), which Calcutta disowned (Purandar) → a reason Parliament strengthened central control in 1784 and 1833. Munro's Ryotwari in Madras → extended by Elphinstone to Bombay → compare with Bengal's Permanent Settlement in Mains answers.

16. UPSC syllabus map and past questions

This whole chapter sits in three places of the UPSC syllabus, and the same facts are asked from three angles: history facts in Prelims, analysis in GS-I Mains, and constitutional evolution in Polity.

Syllabus part	Exact area	What they ask from this chapter
Prelims GS Paper I	History of India and Indian National Movement	Firsts, treaties, battles, acts, institutions, land revenue systems, chronology
Prelims GS Paper I (Polity)	Historical background of the Constitution (Laxmikanth, Ch. 1)	Regulating Act 1773, Pitt's India Act 1784, Charter Acts 1793/1813/1833/1853
Mains GS-I	Modern Indian history from about the middle of the 18th century: significant events, personalities, issues	Reforms of Warren Hastings, Cornwallis; Subsidiary Alliance; Doctrine of Lapse; land revenue systems; education and press policy; causes of 1857
Mains GS-II	Historical underpinnings and evolution of the Constitution; civil services	Charter Acts, origins of civil services (Cornwallis, 1853 open competition)
Mains GS-III	Land reforms in India	Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari, Mahalwari as the colonial background

Syllabus part	Exact area	What they ask from this chapter
Essay	Themes such as colonialism, education, press freedom	Examples: Bengal famine 1770, Macaulay, Metcalfe, Dalhousie's railways

Prelims questions UPSC has asked from this period

Year	Question topic	Answer / point to remember
2004	Order of annexation: Jhansi, Sambalpur, Satara	Satara (1848) → Sambalpur (1849) → Jhansi (1853–54)
2006	Statements on the Charter Act of 1853	Separated legislative and executive functions; open competition
2007	"Clive was the first GG of Bengal; Bentinck the first GG of India"	Only the Bentinck statement is right; Warren Hastings was the first GG of Bengal (Marks UPSC)
2010	Who created the Covenanted Civil Service (later ICS)?	**Cornwallis** (Education Province)
2011	Effect of the Permanent Settlement	Rise in litigation, zamindars' position (PMF IAS)
2012	Features of the Ryotwari Settlement	Rent paid directly to government; pattas given to ryots
2017	Who introduced the Ryotwari Settlement?	**Alexander Read and Thomas Munro**, not Cornwallis (PMF IAS)
2018	What led to English education in India?	Charter Act 1813, General Committee of Public Instruction 1823, and the Orientalist–Anglicist controversy — all three
2018	Pairs: Sanskrit College Benares, Calcutta Madrasa, Fort William College	Only Calcutta Madrasa–Warren Hastings is correct
2019	Statements on the Charter Act of 1813	Ended monopoly except tea and China trade; asserted Crown sovereignty; Rs 1 lakh for education (Drishti IAS)

Year	Question topic	Answer / point to remember
2023	Which Act made the GG of Bengal the GG of India?	**Charter Act of 1833**
2024	Revenue collection under Cornwallis	Permanent Settlement and Sunset Law features
2026	British policy in Awadh after the 1856 annexation	Summary settlement against the taluqdars → a cause of the 1857 revolt in Awadh

Mains themes to prepare from this chapter

- Reforms of Warren Hastings and how they laid the base of British administration.
- Cornwallis' judicial, police and civil service reforms and the Cornwallis Code.
- Compare Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari and Mahalwari; their effect on peasants.
- Subsidiary Alliance and Doctrine of Lapse as tools of expansion.
- Dalhousie as "annexer and moderniser": how both fed the Revolt of 1857.
- Evolution of British education policy: Madrasa (1781) → 1813 → Macaulay (1835) → Wood (1854).
- Evolution of press control: 1799 → 1823 → 1835.
- Social reforms: Sati (1829), slavery (1843), widow remarriage (1856) and the role of Indian reformers.

Memory hook — "Three doors to one chapter"

- **History door** (Prelims and GS-I): wars, treaties, reforms.
- **Polity door** (Prelims and GS-II): the Acts of 1773, 1784, 1793, 1813, 1833, 1853.
- **Economy door** (GS-III): Zamindari, Ryotwari, Mahalwari.
- Every Governor-General's notes should answer three questions: **what did he fight, what did he pass, what did he build?**

17. Master memory system: the whole period as one story

Order of the Governor-Generals

"Warren Can Shoot Well, But Mighty Hastings Ate Bananas — Mother Asked Every Hungry Daughter"

Warren Hastings → **C**ornwallis → **S**hore → **W**ellesley → **B**arlow → **M**into I → **H**astings (Moira) → **A**mherst → **B**entinck → **M**etcalfe → **A**uckland → **E**llenborough → **H**ardinge → **D**alhousie.

Before them, the Governors of Bengal: **"Clive's Van, Vere, Cart"** — Clive, Vansittart, Verelst, Cartier (Clive returns between Vansittart and Verelst).

The policy pendulum (one word per phase)

Fence → Stay out → Ally → Stay out → Rule → Reform → Forward → Swallow

Phase	Governor-General	Policy
Fence	Warren Hastings	Ring-fence (buffer states such as Awadh)
Stay out	Cornwallis (mostly), Shore	Non-intervention (Pitt's Act, 1784)
Ally	Wellesley	Subsidiary Alliance
Stay out	Cornwallis II, Barlow, Minto I	Non-intervention again, diplomacy
Rule	Lord Hastings	Paramountcy, intervention and war
Reform	Bentinck, Metcalfe	Social, educational, press reform
Forward	Auckland, Ellenborough, Hardinge	Forward policy in the North-West (Afghanistan, Sindh, Punjab)
Swallow	Dalhousie	Annexation (Lapse, war, misrule)

Eight threads that connect the events

1. **Bengal thread:** Plassey 1757 → Buxar 1764 → Allahabad 1765 → Dual Government → Famine 1770 → Regulating Act 1773 →

Permanent Settlement 1793.

2. **Mysore thread (treaties "M-M-S-S"):** I (1767–69, Treaty of **M**adras) → II (1780–84, **M**angalore) → III (1790–92, **S**eringapatam) → IV (1799, **S**eringapatam falls, Tipu dies) → Tipu's sons at Vellore → Vellore Mutiny 1806 → Mysore taken over 1831 → restored 1881.
3. **Maratha thread ("Sal-Bas-Poo"):** I War ends at **Sal**bai 1782 → Kharda 1795 → **Bas**sein 1802 → II War (Deogaon, Surji-Anjangaon, Rajghat) → III War and Treaty of **Poo**na 1817 → Peshwa to Bithur → Satara lapses 1848 → Nana Saheb's pension stopped → 1857.
4. **North-West thread:** Amritsar 1809 → Ropar meeting 1831 → Sindh treaty 1832 → Tripartite Treaty 1838 → Ranjit Singh dies 1839 → Kabul disaster 1842 → Sindh annexed 1843 → Sikh War I (Lahore, Amritsar, Bhairowal 1846) → Sikh War II → Punjab annexed 1849.
5. **East thread:** Nepal (Sugauli 1816) → Burma I (Yandabo 1826; Barrackpore 1824) → Burma II (Pegu 1852) → Burma III (1885, outside this chapter).
6. **Constitution thread:** Regulating 1773 → Settlement 1781 → Pitt 1784 → Act of 1786 → Charter Acts every 20 years, all ending in 3: **1793, 1813, 1833, 1853** → Government of India Act 1858.
7. **Education thread:** Calcutta Madrasa 1781 → Asiatic Society 1784 → Benares Sanskrit College 1791 → Fort William College 1800 → Rs 1 lakh 1813 → Hindu College 1817 → General Committee of Public Instruction 1823 → Sanskrit College Calcutta 1824 → Macaulay and English Education Act 1835 → Roorkee 1847 → Wood's Despatch 1854 → universities 1857.
8. **Mutiny thread ("Batta, Hat, Sea, Cartridge"):** White Mutiny 1766 (batta) → Vellore 1806 (hat) → Barrackpore 1824 (sea) → 1857 (cartridge).

Other short threads: **Press** 1799 → 1823 → 1835. **Social reform** Sati 1829 → Slavery 1843 → Widow Remarriage 1856. **Revenue** farming 1772 → Permanent 1793 → Ryotwari 1820 → Mahalwari 1822.

Titles and nicknames (one-line recall)

Title	Person
Heaven-born general; Clive of India	Robert Clive
First GG of Bengal; only GG impeached	Warren Hastings
Father of the Civil Services in India	Cornwallis
Bengal Tiger	Wellesley
Tiger of Mysore	Tipu Sultan
Lion of Punjab	Ranjit Singh
First GG of India; most liberal GG	William Bentinck
Liberator of the Indian Press	Charles Metcalfe
Father of the Ryotwari System	Thomas Munro
Thuggee Sleeman	William Henry Sleeman
Magna Carta of English education	Wood's Despatch, 1854
Father of Indian Railways; maker of modern India	Dalhousie

Ten traps UPSC sets

1. Clive = first **Governor** of Bengal; Warren Hastings = first **GG of Bengal**; Bentinck = first **GG of India**; Canning = first **Viceroy**.
2. **Warren** Hastings (1772–85) is not **Lord** Hastings / Moira (1813–23).
3. Fort William College = **Richard** Wellesley, not Arthur.
4. Benares Sanskrit College = **Jonathan Duncan**, not William Jones; Asiatic Society = William Jones.
5. Two Treaties of Amritsar: **1809** (Ranjit Singh) and **1846** (Gulab Singh).
6. Two Treaties of Lahore: **1846** (end of Sikh War I) and **1849** (annexation).
7. Awadh (1856) was annexed for **misrule**, not under the Doctrine of Lapse.

8. Widow Remarriage Act was passed under **Canning** (1856), though prepared under Dalhousie.
9. Ryotwari = **Read and Munro**; Permanent Settlement = Cornwallis; Mahalwari = **Holt Mackenzie**.
10. Battle of Buxar was won by **Hector Munro** (not Clive, not Thomas Munro).

How to make it stay for life

- Each Governor-General has three hooks above: **what he fought, what he passed, what he built**. Close the notes and say these aloud for each name, in order.
- Revise this document on **day 1, 3, 7, 21 and 60**, the same rhythm as the mistake book in your Prelims Arena app; turn the "Ten traps" into questions there.
- Retell each thread (above) as a story without looking. A chain is easier to keep than a list, because each event reminds you of the next.

Sources: Spectrum, *A Brief History of Modern India*; M. Laxmikanth, *Indian Polity*; Bipan Chandra; Vision IAS, Vajiram and Ravi and GKToday notes; UPSC Prelims papers. Written in my own words for study. Dates for minor items vary slightly between books.